

Minsik Choi (최민식)

Integrated B.S./M.S. Student, Korea University | Efficient LLMs, Model Merging & Transformer Optimization
mszzang2002@korea.ac.kr | +82 10-8700-5813 | Seoul, South Korea

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Hardware-aware transformer optimization for efficient on-device NLP inference
- Model merging for scalable, distributed post-training of large language models
- Geometric and spectral analysis of task interactions in weight space

EDUCATION

Korea University <i>Integrated B.S./M.S. Program, Department of Computer Science and Engineering</i> • Advisor: Prof. Young Geun Kim	Sep. 2025 – Aug. 2027 (expected) Seoul, Korea
University of Tübingen <i>Exchange Student, Computer Science</i>	Sep. 2023 – Feb. 2024 Tübingen, Germany
Korea University <i>B.S. in Computer Science and Engineering</i> • Admitted via the School of Interdisciplinary Studies · GPA: 4.2 / 4.5	Mar. 2022 – Feb. 2026 Seoul, Korea

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

FuriosaAI <i>AI Research Engineering Intern, Algorithm Team</i>	Sep. 2026 – Present Seoul, Korea
NAVER Cloud <i>Research & Engineering Intern</i> • Contributed to a government-funded sovereign foundation model initiative (독자 파운데이션 모델 프로젝트), supporting the development of proprietary large language models. • Designed and ran research on LLM training and evaluation pipelines, including instruction tuning and model merging.	Sep. 2025 – Mar. 2026 Seongnam, Korea
Intelligent Computer Architecture & Systems Lab <i>Undergraduate Research Intern, Korea University (Advisor: Prof. Young Geun Kim)</i> • Hardware-aware transformer optimization and structured pruning for efficient on-device NLP inference.	Feb. 2025 – Feb. 2026 Seoul, Korea

PUBLICATIONS

*co-first author †corresponding author

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers

- [C1] [Minsik Choi*](#), Geewook Kim*, Young Geun Kim, “Text Capability Loss in Vision-Language Adaptation: An Attention-Sink Diagnosis,” *Proc. of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2026. **Main Conference.**
- [C2] [Minsik Choi*](#), Hyegang Son*, Changhoon Kim, Young Geun Kim, “Entropy Meets Importance: A Unified Head Importance–Entropy Score for Stable and Efficient Transformer Pruning,” *Findings of EMNLP*, 2026. Extended version of [W1].
- [C3] [Minsik Choi*](#), Geewook Kim*†, “Decentralized Instruction Tuning: Conflict-Aware Splitting and Weight Merging,” *Proc. of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2026.

Manuscripts Under Review

- [R1] [Minsik Choi](#) (co-first author), “Merging RLVR-Trained Experts via Policy-Shift-Guided Spectral Alignment.” Under review.

Peer-Reviewed Workshop Papers

- [W1] [Minsik Choi](#), Hyegang Son, Changhoon Kim, Young Geun Kim, “Entropy Meets Importance: A Unified Head Importance–Entropy Score for Stable and Efficient Transformer Pruning,” *NeurIPS 2025 Workshop*.

Technical Reports

[T1] NAVER Cloud HyperCLOVA X Team, “HyperCLOVA X 8B Omni Technical Report,” 2026.
[T2] NAVER Cloud HyperCLOVA X Team, “HyperCLOVA X 32B Think Technical Report,” 2026.

Tech Blog Posts

[B1] Minsik Choi, Kiuk Kim, “충돌은 나누고, 성능은 합치다: 효율적인 LLM Post-training 전략 MERIT,” *NAVER CLOVA Tech Blog*, Jul. 2026. Covers [C3]. [link](#)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer, OPT 2026: Optimization for Machine Learning <i>NeurIPS 2026 Workshop</i>	2026
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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research areas: LLM post-training (instruction tuning, RLVR / reinforcement fine-tuning); model merging and weight-space arithmetic for distributed post-training; transformer efficiency and structured / attention-head pruning; vision-language and multimodal models; efficient on-device inference. Methods & analysis: spectral and geometric analysis of task interactions in weight space; head importance–entropy scoring; attention-sink diagnosis for vision-language adaptation; large-scale training and evaluation pipeline design. Programming & frameworks: Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers; distributed / large-scale training (DeepSpeed, FSDP); CUDA; Git, Linux. Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent).	
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SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

Graduate Merit-Based Scholarship, Korea University <i>50% tuition, all semesters — awarded for academic excellence</i>	Feb. 2026 – Aug. 2027
Woonhae Scholarship Foundation Academic Scholarship <i>Merit-based scholarship covering full tuition for one academic year</i>	2025